

Instructional Material Updates

Instructional material for export operations is transitioning into new templates. The updates are being made to meet department style requirements, facilitate improved document management and make it quicker and easier for users to find the instructions they need.

As documents are transitioned into the new templates, you may find some documents titled according to the new naming convention and others that are still titled according to the previous naming convention.

More information can be found in [IAN 2024-08: Plant Export Operations – Ongoing conversion of instructional material](#).

Instructional material has been prepared by the department and published on the Plant Export Operations Manual (PEOM) to provide information that directs and supports industry and authorised officers (AOs) to understand their responsibilities and perform their roles relating to the export of prescribed plants and plant products from Australia to ensure the objects of the Export Control Act 2020 are met.

Exports Policy (previously Departmental Policy) describes the rules that must be followed or requirements that must be met.

Export Process Instructions (previously Guidelines) describe a sequence of events or stages of an activity that different parties in different roles across the export supply chain must complete. Export Process Instructions may also describe rules or requirements relating to the process.

Export Work instructions (previously Work Instructions) provide a step-by-step account of the activities a person in a specific role performs to complete a task. For example, the inspection of plants and plant products, empty containers and vessels for loading by an AO. Export Work Instructions may also describe the rules or requirements relating to the task.

Export References (previously References) contains supporting information to further assist industry and AOs to understand and perform their roles.

Exports System Instructions provide instruction for using an exports system, such as the Plant Exports Management System (PEMS).

This section contains general information relating to the export of all plants and plant products, and the inspection of empty containers and vessels for loading from Australia. For information specific to establishments, transport units, product inspections and documentation refer to the related sections below.

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Authorised Officers

Exporters must use an inspection authorised officer (AO) who has the appropriate appointment for the type of inspection being conducted.

If an exporter is seeking an inspection from a departmental AO a [Request for plant exports inspection appointment](#) form must be completed.

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Equipment

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Document	File size
Reference: Plant exports guide – Equipment PDF	860 KB
Reference: Plant exports guide – Equipment DOCX	8.5 MB

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Specimen collection

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Document	File size
Reference: Plant exports guide – Specimen collection PDF	219 KB
Reference: Plant exports guide – Specimen collection DOCX	97 KB

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Registered establishments

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Auditing registered establishment

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Export compliant goods storage

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Quality System Recognition

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Mobile Bulk Loading

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Handling pest free area products

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Accredited properties include farms and packhouses that are required to be accredited by the department to produce and/or prepare a particular commodity to meet the requirement for recognition by an importing country authority.

Instructional material specific to horticulture export accredited properties can be found below.

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Packhouse growers supplier model

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Horticulture registered establishments and accredited properties are responsible for maintaining phytosanitary security of goods for export held in their premises and during transport from one premises to another. This includes documenting the secure movement of goods using transfer records.

Instructional material specific to phytosanitary security for horticulture exports can be found below.

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Empty container inspection

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Bulk vessel inspection

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Instructional material specific to product inspections can be found below. You will be required to use other export documentation, certification and forms, which can be found under the Documentation section, along with the relevant instructional material.

General

Download

Document	File size
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets PDF	257 KB
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets DOCX	154 KB

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Horticulture

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Grain and plant products

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Cotton

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Hay and straw products

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Forest products

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Phytosanitary treatments being carried out on horticulture for export to protocol markets must occur in registered establishments that have the appropriate treatment function/s under their registration.

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Document	File size
Reference: Use of phytosanitary treatments for plant exports PDF	252 KB
Reference: Use of phytosanitary treatments for plant exports DOCX	86 KB

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Cold treatment

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Dimethoate dipping

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Irradiation

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Methyl bromide fumigation

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Sulfur dioxide/Carbon dioxide fumigation

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Vapour heat treatment

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This section contains information on the issuance of certification for plant exports and completing plant export inspection and treatment records.

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Document	File size
Guideline: Issuance of certification for plant exports PDF	292 KB
Guideline: Issuance of certification for plant exports DOCX	116 KB

Completing export documentation

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Inspection and treatment records

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The Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry [Charging Guidelines](#) provides details about the application of the department's biosecurity and export certification fees and charges applicable to biosecurity, live animal export, plant export and food export programs.

This section contains instructional material for plant export systems:

Manual for importing country requirements (Micor)

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Document

[Manual of importing country requirements \(plants\) HTML](#)

Plant Export Management System (PEMS)

The Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide has been published as separate reference documents.

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Document	Version	Date of release
Process instruction: Quality System Recognition of processed plant products for export	10	17/08/2026
Work instruction: Inspecting processed plant products for export produced under quality systems recognition	4	17/08/2026
Process instruction: Inspection of empty bulk vessels for export	12	1/07/2026
Work instruction: Inspecting empty bulk vessels for export	7	1/07/2026
Reference: Performance standards – plant export authorised officer audits	4	1/07/2026
Process instruction: Supporting documents for plant exports	7	18/05/2026
Work instruction: Completing plant export inspection and treatment record	10	22/04/2026
Process instruction: Inspection of forest products for export	5	16/03/2026
Work instruction: Inspecting forest products for export	4	16/03/2026
Reference: Performance standards for plant export registered establishments	6	03/12/2025
Policy: Management of plant export registered establishments	5	20/11/2025
Reference: Table of authorised officer job functions	24	10/10/2025
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets	17	10/10/2025
Reference: Application for accreditation under the packhouse grower supplier model	N/A	09/05/2025

Process instruction: Inspection of prescribed grain and plant products for export	8	28/04/2025
Work instruction: Inspecting prescribed grain and plant products for export	6	28/04/2025
Policy: Audit of plant export operations	6	22/04/2025
Process instruction: Audit of plant export registered establishments	6	22/04/2025
Process instruction: Audit of plant export authorised officers	2	22/04/2025
Process instruction: Audit of horticulture export accredited properties	6	22/04/2025
Work instruction: Completing plant export inspection and treatment records	10	24/03/2025
Reference: Application for registration of cucurbit growers for freedom from Cucumber Green Mottle Mosaic Virus (CGMMV)	N/A	Rescinded
Process instruction: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	7.0	19/12/2024
Process instruction: Management of horticulture export accredited properties operating under the packhouse grower supplier model	2.0	19/12/2024
Reference: Packhouse management of Growers Template	2.0	19/12/2024
Reference: Performance standards for the packhouse grower supplier model	2.0	19/12/2024
Process instruction: Maintenance of phytosanitary security for horticulture exports	5.0	11/12/2024
Reference: Transfer record for horticulture exports	4.0	11/12/2024
Work instruction: Completing a transfer record for horticulture exports	N/A	Rescinded
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets	15.0	9/12/2024
Reference: Performance standards – Automatic in-line hay sampling	1.0	27/11/2024
Reference: Performance standards - Establishment continuation audits for log exports to China	1.0	20/11/2024
Work Instruction: Inspecting horticulture for export using end-point sampling	5.0	6/11/2024
Work Instruction: Inspecting horticulture for export using in-line sampling	6.0	6/11/2024
Reference: Performance standards - Establishment start up audits for log exports to China	2.0	13/8/2024
Reference: Australian phytosanitary treatment application standard for vapour heat treatment	1.3	23/8/2024
Reference: Registered operation and function codes for plant export registered establishments	10	13/08/2024
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide – Overview and General Functions	21	04/07/2024
Reference: Prescribed goods export preparation standard checklist	3	29/05/2024
Reference: Conduct and communication in a plant export environment	4	24/04/2024
Reference: Pests, diseases and contaminants of horticultural commodities	2	05/04/2024

Reference: Plant exports guide—horticulture inspection techniques	4	05/04/2024
Reference: Defensible decision making for plant export authorised officers	4	05/04/2024
Reference: Plant export operations instructional material glossary of terms	3	05/04/2024
Pre-entry hazard assessment for third-party worksites including bulk vessels (Take 5 checklist)	3	05/04/2024
Table of authorised officer job functions	22	05/04/2024
Work health and safety in the plant export environment	5	05/04/2024
Process instruction: Inspection of prescribed grain and plant products for export	8	29/02/2024
Work instruction: Inspecting forest products for export	3	29/02/2024
Process instruction: Inspection of forest products for export	3	29/02/2024
Reference: Guideline: Inspection of prescribed grain and plant products for export	7	31/01/2024
Reference: Plant exports guide – bulk woodchips inspection techniques	4	18/01/2024
Reference: Pests, diseases and contaminants of horticultural commodities	1	18/01/2024
Departmental Policy: Management of plant export registered establishments	3	04/01/2024
Work Instruction: Inspecting prescribed grain and plant products for export	5	29/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of prescribed grain and plant products for export	7	29/11/2023
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets	14	28/11/2023
Guideline: Quality System Recognition of highly processed plant products for export	9	24/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of hay and straw for export	3	24/11/2023
Guideline: Mobile Bulk Loading of prescribed goods for export	3	24/11/2023
Work Instruction: Inspecting cotton for export	3	24/11/2023
Reference: Export compliant goods storage	3	24/11/2023
Work Instruction: Inspecting empty containers for export	3	24/11/2023
Work Instruction: Initiating an in-transit cold treatment for plant exports	8	24/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of empty containers for export	3	24/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of empty bulk vessels for export	11	24/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of horticulture for export	5	24/11/2023
Guideline: Inspection of cotton for export	5	24/11/2023
Guideline: Audit of plant export registered establishments	6	24/11/2023
Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	6	01/11/2023
Guideline: Audit of horticulture export accredited properties	5	01/11/2023
Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	6	01/11/2023
Guideline: Audit of horticulture export accredited properties	5	01/11/2023
	1	01/11/2023

Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties operating under the packhouse grower supplier model		
Reference: Packhouse management of Growers Template	1	01/11/2023
Reference: Performance standards for the packhouse grower supplier model	1	01/11/2023
Reference: Application for plant export accreditation of farms	N/A	01/11/2023
Reference: Application for plant export accreditation of packhouses	N/A	01/11/2023
Reference: Application for accreditation under the packhouse grower supplier model	N/A	01/11/2023
Reference: Registered operation and function codes for plant export registered establishments	9	28/09/2023
Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	5	12/09/2023
Guideline: Supporting documents for plant exports	6	12/09/2023
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide – Quality System Recognition Inspections	17	22/08/2023
Guideline: Inspection of forest products for export	2	14/08/2023
Work Instruction: Inspecting forest products for export	2	14/08/2023
Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	4	07/08/2023
Guideline: Audit of horticulture export accredited properties	4	07/08/2023
Performance standards – onshore cold treatment – horticulture exports	5	07/08/2023
Vapour heat treatment sensor calibration record	4	04/07/2023
Vapour heat treatment record	4	04/07/2023
Reference: Performance standards – vapour heat treatment – horticulture exports	5	04/07/2023
Guideline: Supporting documents for plant exports	5	04/07/2023
Reference: Plant export operations instructional material glossary of terms	1	04/07/2023
Work Instruction: Inspecting empty bulk vessels for export	7	04/07/2023
Guideline: Inspection of empty bulk vessels for export	10	04/07/2023
Reference: Conduct and communication in a plant export environment	3	04/07/2023
Reference: Registered operation and function codes for plant export registered establishments	7	08/05/2023
Work instruction: Inspecting empty bulk vessel for export	6	05/05/2023
Guideline: Inspection of empty bulk vessels for export	9	13/04/2023
Reference: Australian phytosanitary treatment application standard for vapour heat treatment	1.2	20/03/2023
Reference: Pre-entry hazard assessment for third party worksites including bulk vessels (Take 5 checklist)	2	17/03/2023
Reference: Conduct and communication in a plant export environment	2	25/10/2022
Reference: Defensible decision making for plant export authorised officers	3	25/10/2022

Reference: Plant export document and treatments checklist superseded by Reference: Documentation checklist for plant exports	N/A	Rescinded
Dry box empty inspection entomology superseded by Inspecting empty containers for insects.	N/A	Rescinded
Reference: Australian phytosanitary treatment application standard for vapour heat treatment	1.1	10/10/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide – Grain and Plant Product inspections	18	4/10/2022
Departmental Policy: Management of plant export registered establishments	2	01/10/2022
Guideline: Audit of plant export registered establishments	5	01/10/2022
Reference: Performance standards for plant export registered establishments	5	01/10/2022
Guideline: Management of horticulture export accredited properties	4	01/10/2022
Guideline: Audit of horticulture export accredited properties	4	01/10/2022
Reference: Performance standards for packhouses	5	01/10/2022
Reference: Performance standards – irradiation treatment – horticulture exports	4	15/09/2022
Reference: Performance standards – Sulfur Dioxide (SO ₂) Carbon Dioxide (CO ₂) fumigation – horticulture exports	3	15/09/2022
Guideline: Supporting documents for plant exports	4	13/09/2022
Reference: Authorised officer audit performance standards	2	29/08/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide – Overview and General Functions	19	11/08/2022
Guideline: Inspection of prescribed grain and plant products for export	6	02/08/2022
Volume 13: Phytosanitary certification overview	N/A	Rescinded
Volume 18: Export documentation – electronic	N/A	Rescinded
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised officer user guide – Bulk vessel inspections	13	26/07/2022
Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised officer user guide – Bulk into ship hold inspections	16	26/07/2022
Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Horticulture inspections	15	25/07/2022
Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised officer user guide – Quality System Recognition Inspections	16	25/07/2022
Reference: Empty Container Sticker Stencil	N/A	19/07/2022
Reference: Empty Container Inspection Record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Bulk into Ship Hold Inspection Record	3	19/07/2022
Reference: Horticulture Inspection Record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Grain and Plant Product Inspection Record	2	19/07/2022

Reference: Onshore cold treatment record	4	19/07/2022
Reference: Certificate of loading and calibration record for an in-transit cold treatment	3	19/07/2022
Reference: Bulk Vessel Loading Running Record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Bulk Vessel Inspection Record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Vapour heat treatment record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Vapour heat treatment sensor calibration record	2	19/07/2022
Reference: Performance standards – irradiation treatment – horticulture exports	4	01/07/2022
Reference: Performance standards – Sulfur Dioxide (SO ₂) Carbon Dioxide (CO ₂) fumigation – horticulture exports	2	30/06/2022
Reference: Performance standards – handling fruit fly pest free (PFA) product outside of a PFA	2	30/06/2022
Reference: Performance standards – methyl bromide fumigation – horticulture exports	2	30/06/2022
Reference: Performance standards – vapour heat treatment – horticulture exports	5	30/06/2022
Guideline: Inspection of cotton for export	4	27/05/2022
Work Instruction: Inspecting cotton for export	2	27/05/2022
Reference: Performance standards – washing potatoes for export to the Republic of Korea	1	23/05/2022
Guideline: Inspection of empty containers for export	2	9/05/2022
Work Instruction: Inspecting empty containers for export	2	9/05/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide - Quality System Recognition Inspections	15	7/04/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide – Overview and General Functions	18	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised officer user guide – Empty container inspections	12	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide - Grain and Plant Product inspections	16	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Horticulture inspections	14	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide - Bulk into ship hold inspections	15	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Onshore cold treatment calibrations	10	4/04/2022
Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Vapour heat treatment	3	4/04/2022

Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Horticulture inspections	13	16/03/2022
Reference: Table of authorised officer job functions	19	16/03/2022
Reference: Plant Export Management System authorised officer user guide – Vapour heat treatment	2	21/02/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide - Bulk into ship hold inspections	14	21/02/2022
Reference: Plant Exports Management System (PEMS) Authorised Officer User Guide - Grain and Plant Product Inspections	15	21/02/2022
Reference: Table of plant export protocol markets	13	14/02/2022
Work Instruction: Inspecting empty bulk vessels for export	5	1/01/2022
Guideline: Inspection of empty bulk vessels for export	8	1/01/2022
Reference: Performance standards for plant export registered establishments	4	1/01/2022
Departmental Policy: Management of plant export registered establishments	1	1/01/2022
Guideline: Management of plant export registered establishments		
Superseded by Departmental Policy: Management of plant export registered establishments	na	Rescinded

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/plants-plant-products/plantexportsmanual>